



Substance Abuse and Mental Health
Services Administration

Find Support



How to Cope With Mental Health, Drug, and Alcohol Issues

Has it gotten harder to get through each day? If you're having issues with mental health, drugs, or alcohol or waiting for treatment to start, here are some small steps you can take.

Reach out if you're in crisis

If you or someone you know is struggling or in crisis, help is available. Call or text [988](tel:988) or chat 988lifeline.org . You'll be able to speak with a trained crisis counselor any time of day or night.

Accept where you are now

Know that where you are is okay. Healing isn't a straight line—there will be ups and downs along the way. Speak to yourself with kindness, as though you're speaking to a friend.

Try some of the things below to help your body and mind. Taking care of yourself is healing yourself. Self-care is different for everyone, so you may have to try a few things before finding what works for you.

Take care of your body

- [Get enough sleep](#)—if you can, stick to a regular schedule
- If it's safe, spend time outside

- Play sports you enjoy or other types of exercise—even if it's just stretching or walking

Take care of your mind

- Write or draw your feelings
- Take a few deep breaths to calm your mind and slow your heart rate
- Take a break from news or social media if it causes you stress
- Explore your interests and hobbies
- If you can, follow a regular schedule each day and build in time to take breaks
- Celebrate large and small successes

Connect with people for support

- When you feel ready, think about [asking for help](#)
- Join a [support group](#) or connect with an online community that's a safe space
- Talk to people who care about you and won't judge you—and be open to their advice
- If you're in a safe relationship, be open with your partner about what you're going through
- Get involved with a sports team, school activity, or a religious or spiritual organization
- Volunteer for a cause you care about

If you find yourself in crisis — or you just need to talk to someone — call or text [988](#) for help.

If you've experienced a traumatic event or disaster, [find additional coping tips](#).

How to ask for help

Signs that you might need help

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<https://www.samhsa.gov/find-support/how-to-cope>